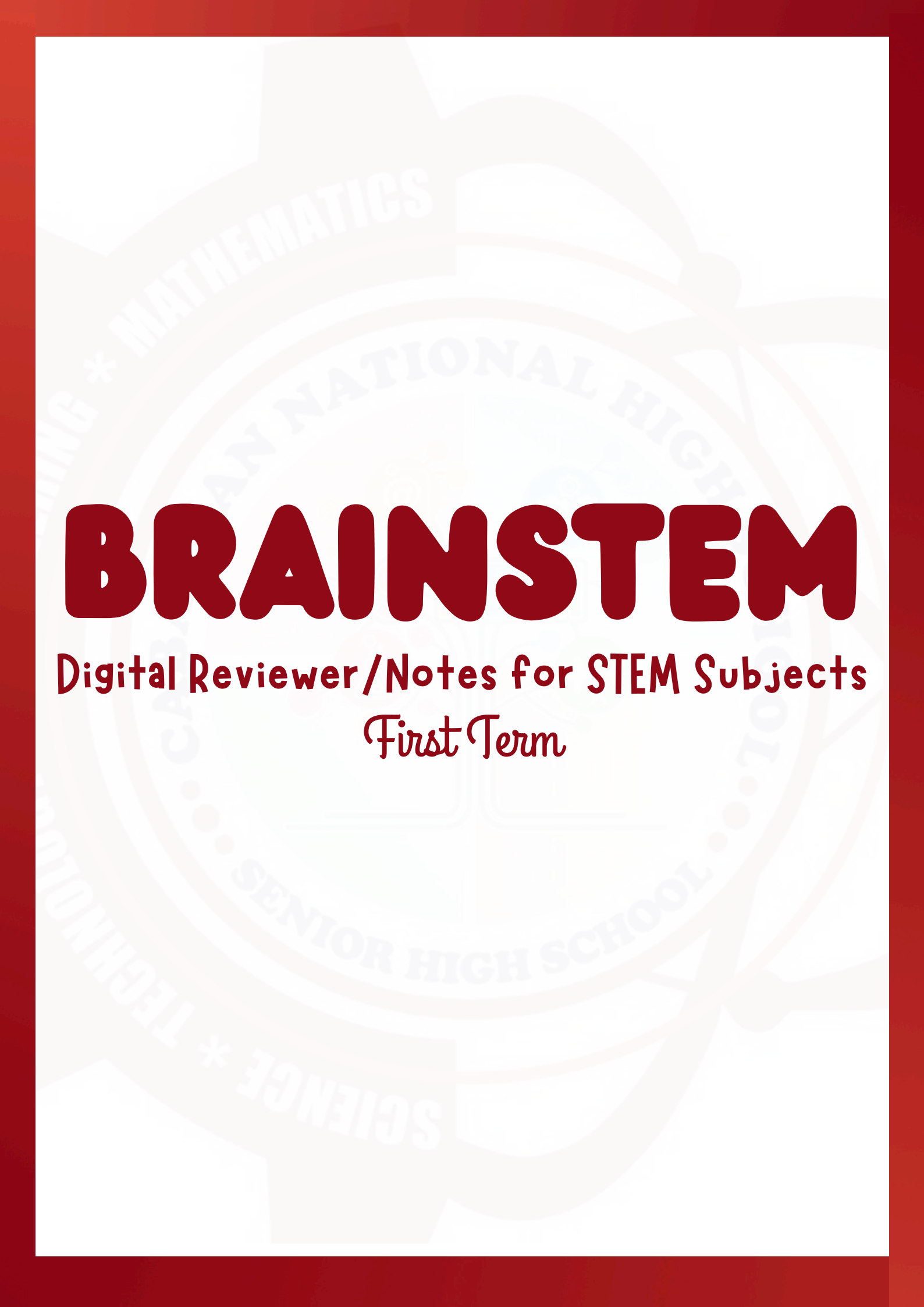




BRAINSTEM

Digital Reviewer/Notes for STEM Subjects
First Term

INTRODUCTION TO PHILOSOPHY OF THE HUMAN PERSON



Philosophy

-the study or discipline that uses human reason to investigate the ultimate causes, reasons, and principles which govern all things.

-derived from the greek word "philo" means love and "sophia" means wisdom. (love for wisdom)

-a never ending searching for truth

Knowledge -simply what we know

Wisdom -knowing why, how and what we can do from it (how we apply)

Branches of Philosophy

1. **Ethics** -explores the nature of moral virtue and evaluates human action

2. **Epistemology** -deals with nature, sources, limitations, and validity of knowledge

3. **Aesthetics** -the science of the beautiful and its various manifestations

4. **Logic** -the branch of philosophy which deals with correct reasoning.

Great Philosophers

PHYTAGORAS

- a mathematician and scientist, and was credited with formulating the Pythagorean Theorem

SOCRATES

- considered the foremost philosopher of ancient times

HERACLITUS

- everything that exists is based on a higher order or plan he called logos

DEMOCRITUS

- he devoted himself to the study of the causes of natural phenomena

EPICURUS

- he believed that philosophy could enable man to live a life of happiness

PLATO

- his teachings and writings were considered the foundation of western philosophy

ARISTOTLE

- a prominent student of plato

THE GREENK PHILOSOPHER PLATO believes that philosophy is brought about by Man's sense of **WONDER**

DOUBT Rene Descartes considers this as a reason why people philosophize

KARL JASPERS believes that persons engage in philosophy is order to make sense of difficult life experiences

FRAMEWORK refers to way of thinking about the world and is made up of a person's views and beliefs

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INTERNAL QUESTIONS These are questions that examine personal ideas regarding correctness and values.

EXTERNAL QUESTIONS These are questions that seek to question the very frameworks upon which people base their own beliefs and views.

HOLISTIC THINKING It refers to a perspective that considers large scale patterns in systems and often described as looking at the "bigger picture" when describing and analyzing situation or problem.

PARTIAL THINKING It is a type of thinking that focuses on specific aspects of situation.

REFLECTION These requires a person to be willing to examine one's thoughts, feelings and actions and to learn more about one's life and experiences.

KNOWLEDGE It refers to the clear awareness and understanding of something.

FACTS These are statements which are observed to be real or truthful.

CLAIMS These are statements which need to be examines to determine whether they are true or false.

OPINION These are comprised of statements that provide views on a certain matter.

CONCLUSION This is a judgement based on certain facts.

BELIEFS These are statements thta express convictions that are not easily explained by facts.

EXPLANATIONS These are statements that assume a claim is true and provide reasons to support them.

ARGUMENTS This is a series of statements that provide reasons to convince a person that a claim or opinion is truthful.

FALLACIES These are arguments based on faulty reasoning.

BIASES These are tendencies or influences that affect the views of people.

HUMAN This term refers to man as a species and distinguishes man from other animals. **PERSON** This refers to the totality of an individual who possesses awareness, self-determination. and the capacity to interact with others.

SELF This refers to an individual who is actively aware that he or she is perceiving and experiencing reality.

INTERIORITY This refers to the ability of the person to experience an "inner world" that is defined by personal thoughts and ideas.

SELF DETERMINATION This is the capability to act and be aware of one's actions.

FREE WILL This enables the person to act whenever he or she wants to and makes self-determination possile.

EXTERNALITY This refers to the capability to reach out and interact with others and the world.

DIGNITY This refers to the inherent value of a person which cannot be exressed in quantifiable terms.

SPIRIT This refers to the intangible element that enables us to exercise thought, possess awareness, and reach out to the outside world and others.

TRANSCENDENCE - This is the ability to surpass limits.

INTRODUCTION TO PHILOSOPHY OF THE HUMAN PERSON



Human Person In the Environment

Humankind

- is part of the world, and we significantly affect our environment in the same way that changes in our environment affect us.

Environmental Philosophy/Ethics

- the discipline in Philosophy that studies moral relationship of human beings with the environment and its non-human contents.

3 MAJOR VIEWS

1. Anthropocentrism

- believes that humans are the most important species on the planet and they are free to transform nature and use its resources

2. Biocentrism

- his view drives the activities of humane organization that advocate the ethical treatment of animals R.A. 8485 "The Animal Welfare Act of 1998"

3. Ecocentrism

- places great value on ecosystems and biological system or community and that we have a significant roles as stewards or guardians of nature.
- promotes the idea that order and balance in nature brings about stability and beauty
- emphasizes the important role of the interaction between living and non- living components of the environment

The influence of humanity the environment can be best understood if we consider the individual person as a dynamic source of change within his or her particular environment

Environmental Aesthetic

- a philosophical view that believes maintaining order in the environment will bring out the natural beauty of the surroundings and contribute to the well-being of people and other organisms living in it.
- the appreciation of natural beauty brings about concern for the environment and helps people relate more effectively with nature

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

- is development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.

2 key concepts of Sustainable Development

1. Needs

- in particular the essential needs of the world's poor

2. Limitations

- imposed by the state of technology and social organization on the environment's ability to meet present and future needs

THREE IMPORTANT PRINCIPLES OF SUSTAINABILITY

1. Environmental Integrity

- refers to maintaining the state of the environment. This means that human activities should not disrupt the ecosystem and human communities located in the area

2. Economic efficiency

- refers to prudence in decision making regarding the use of resources to ensure there is minimum to zero waste.

- **Prudence** is the ability to regulate one's actions and behavior.

3. Equity

- demands that we use our natural resources in such a manner that these are conserved so that the next generation will be able to use them.
- **Frugality** is being thrifty with the use of one's resources.

VALUE

- **Intrinsic Value** -if it has inherent worth in itself
- **Instrumental Value** -if something is considered as a means towards achieving a certain end

Freedom Of The Human Person

Freedom

- is an intrinsic and essential property of the person. This means that the human person by nature is a free being and that it is in his or her nature to seek freedom.
- An essential quality of every human person.
- The ability to make choices and act freely.
- Allows people to think, decide, and take responsibility for their actions.
- Distinguishes humans from other living beings.

Freedom as Self Determination

- Freedom is the power to decide who we want to become.
- Our choices help shape our personality, talents, and future.
- We develop ourselves through the decisions we make.
- Freedom allows us to pursue our goals and dreams.

INTRODUCTION TO PHILOSOPHY OF THE HUMAN PERSON



KINDS OF FREEDOM

Physical Freedom

• Refers to the absence of any physical restraint. The freedom of mobility to go where he or she wants to go. He or she is not impeded in his or her actions by any physical force.

Key Components Of Physical Freedom

Freedom of Mobility: The most basic form. It means being able to travel, walk through your neighborhood, or relocate without physical barriers, lockdowns, or confinement.

Bodily Autonomy: Having control over your own physical being. It involves making decisions about your own physical health, well-being, and daily activities.

Absence of Coercion: Not being forced, bound, or physically coerced by other individuals, authorities, or oppressive systems to do something against your will.

Physical Vitality: The ability to engage in activities like sports, dancing, or manual labor without being hindered by pain, illness, or bodily limitations.

Psychological Freedom

• Also called the freedom of choice. The person is free to perform actions that he or she considers right and wise. A person is also free to act or not to act. Psychological freedom is innate and cannot be denied a person.

Moral Freedom

• Refers to using freedom in a manner that upholds human dignity and goodness. Freedom is not an object that a person may use in whatever way he or she pleases. A person must use his or her freedom to grow as a person. A person becomes more free when he or she uses freedom well.

Pillars of Moral Freedom

1. REASON- You use your mind, not just emotions

You think: "If I cheat, is that fair to those who studied?"

2. CONSCIENCE- Your inner voice that knows right/wrong

You feel guilty even if no one sees you lie.

3. FREE WILL-No one is forcing you to choose. You "can" copy, but you "choose" not to.

4. RESPONSIBILITY- You accept the result of your choice. You failed because you played games. You own it.

5. DIGNITY- You respect yourself and others. You don't bully because it degrades a person. If one of these is missing, it's not full moral freedom.

3 Level of Moral Freedom

LEVEL 1: FREEDOM FROM- Free from force and pressure

Example: No one is holding a gun to your head to cheat. You have a choice.

LEVEL 2: FREEDOM TO- Free to choose the good

Example: You choose to study, to help, to be honest even when it's hard.

Level 3: FREEDOM FOR- Free for a purpose - to become a better person

Example: You choose discipline now so you can become a good engineer/doctor later.

This is the deepest level. You're not just avoiding bad. You're aiming for good.

Elements of Freedom

Responsibility

• being accountable for the consequences of one's actions. Since every choice has an outcome, a person must accept both the positive and negative results of the decisions they freely make.

Voluntariness

• means that a person acts freely and willingly, without being forced or coerced. A voluntary action is done by one's own choice, making the person accountable for it. If someone is forced to act, their freedom and responsibility may be reduced.

Question to Guide Our Choices

Before making a decision, ask yourself:

- What should I do?
- Why should I do it?
- What will happen if I do it?
- How will my actions affect myself and others?
- Is my action right, beneficial, and moral?

Human Freedom

• Human freedom gives us the ability to think of countless decision and possible actions, we only get to choose to enact one of the possible actions or decisions.

Freedom Through Making Choices

- Having the ability to choose and enact a course of action does not automatically mean that we should take action every time. It is also possible that the choice not to take action may be an acceptable and moral choice in a given situation.
- Real life is not a movie where we can stop and rewind events and get a "second take" on the situation. Therefore, it is very important that when confronted with choices, we exercise caution and prudence and reflect on our possible course of action.

Self Reflection

• Self-reflection is essential in the proper exercise of freedom. It helps us avoid acting based on impulse or emotions and encourages us to think about the effects of our actions. By reflecting before we decide, we can make wiser choices that benefit ourselves and others.

INTRODUCTION TO PHILOSOPHY OF THE HUMAN PERSON



How Can I exercise my freedom in a responsible and beneficial manner

- Human freedom is not absolute. Although we are free to make our own choices, we must exercise that freedom with self-control, responsibility, and respect for others. True freedom means recognizing our limits and making decisions that are beneficial rather than harmful.

Freedom and Society

- Our freedom is important, but it is not unlimited. Society creates laws and regulations that set reasonable limits on our actions to protect everyone's rights, maintain peace and order, and promote the common good. These limits help ensure that people can enjoy their freedom without harming others.

INTERSUBJECTIVITY

Example from In a Heartbeat

- Sherwin's feelings were real and important to him. Jonathan's acceptance showed recognition of another person's emotions*

Example from The Present

- The boy initially focused on the puppy's disability. Later, he recognized the puppy's value beyond its physical condition.*

INTERSUBJECTIVITY

- It is the mutual awareness, understanding, and relationship between persons.
- It is the condition of man, a subject, among other men, who are also subjects.
- It refers to the shared awareness and understanding among persons.
- It is made possible by the awareness of the self and the other.

Martin Buber

- an Austrian-born Israeli Jewish philosopher best known for his philosophy of dialogue

"The world is not comprehensible, but it is embraceable: through the embracing of one of its beings."

Importance of intersubjectivity

Without intersubjectivity:	With intersubjectivity:
- People become isolated. - Misunderstandings increase. - Prejudice develops. - Relationships become shallow.	- We understand others better. - We develop empathy. - We build genuine relationships. - We respect human dignity.

The Self

- The self refers to the person who thinks, feels, decides, and acts. It includes: Your beliefs, Emotions, Experiences, Identity

The Other

- The other refers to every person outside of yourself. The other is not an object but a person with Feelings Dreams Struggles Unique experiences

How the self and the other relate

- We often think we know ourselves independently. However, philosophers argue that we discover ourselves through our relationships with others.

How the Self and the Other Are Connected

- You learn patience through dealing with difficult people. You learn kindness by helping others. You discover your strengths and weaknesses through interaction.

Philosophical Perspective

"I-Thou Relationship"

- respecting others
- listening sincerely
- recognizing their dignity

"I-It Relationship"

- using people for personal gain
- ignoring their feelings
- treating them as tools

The Danger of Judging Others

Many conflicts arise because people focus only on appearances

- judging someone based on physical appearance
- making assumptions about a classmate
- excluding people because they are different

What makes an interaction meaningful?

Not all interactions are meaningful. Meaningful interactions involve understanding, respect, and genuine concern.

Dialouge

Dialouge is more than talking. It is genuine exchange where people listen, undertsnd, and respect one another. It requires, openness, honesty, respect, willingness to listen. It is important because it helps us understand different perspectives, resolve misunderstandings, build trust, strengthen relationships

Seeming

- It is a way of approaching the other governed by the image one desires to impress on the other. It involves deliberately playing up or hiding aspects of yourself to appear more desirable or impressive

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Being

- It proceeds not from an image, but from what one really is. It is an acceptance of the other in the way that it is also an acceptance of the self as it is.

Speechifying

- It refers to one's talking past another.
- It is hearing without listening to what one says.

Personal Making Present

- it refers to one's talking past another. It is hearing without listening to what one says.

TENDENCIES THAT MAKE DIALOGUE AND MAKING PRESENT DIFFICULT

Analytical Thinking

- when we break person into parts

Reductive Thinking

- when we reduce the richness of a person to a schema, a structure, and/or a concept

Derivational Thinking

- when we derive the person from a mixed formula

Imposition

- It constitutes holding one's own opinion, values, attitudes and oneself without regard for those of another.
- It is telling the other how he or she should act, behave and respond to things.

Unfolding

- It constitutes finding in the other the disposition toward what one recognizes as true, good and beautiful.
- It involves seeing the other as a unique, singular individual capable of freely actualizing himself/herself.

Sympathy Vs Empathy

WHY IS EMPATHY IMPORTANT?

Empathy helps us:

- Understand others
- Build stronger relationships
- Resolve conflicts peacefully
- Respect people's feelings
- Develop genuine human connections

Erich Fromm: The Art of Loving (1956)

We give more importance to being loved than to loving. People think that to love is easy and what is difficult is to find the right person to love or be loved by.

We confuse the initial falling-in-love with the permanent state of being-in-love.

Love Begins from Loneliness

"The experience of love begins from the experience of loneliness." – Dr. Manuel Dy Jr.

Loneliness

One of the most basic experiences of the human being because of self-awareness.

Ways People Address Loneliness

- Escapism – People distract themselves through drugs, alcohol, sex, excessive entertainment.
- Conformity with Groups people join clubs, organizations, peer groups, fraternities.
- Creative and Productive Work Examples include: art, music, sports, hobbies, writing and meaningful work.

Finding Yourself

"Sometimes you need to lose everyone to find yourself again."

Solitude is the place of purification.

Essential Characteristics of Love

- Love is Historical
- Love is Eternal
- Love is Sacred

What does it mean to be available?

Availability means:

- Being present
- Giving time
- Listening
- Offering support
- Sometimes the best help is simply being there.

Alienation

Alienation occurs when a person feels disconnected from others. Is excluded from a group. Is treated as an object rather than a person.

Human dignity

Every person has value. Not because of, Wealth, Popularity, Appearance, Abilities

Diversity

We are different in Culture, Beliefs, Experiences, Talents, abilities

THE HUMAN PERSON IN THE SOCIETY

"man is by nature a social animal"

No human being can live on its own, and if there is, he is either a beast or God

society

- Organized group of people whose members interact frequently and have common territory and culture
- a companionship or friendly association with others, an alliance, a community or a union

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Social contract

Thomas Hobbes

- Social Contract – an agreement where individuals sacrifice an amount of their freedom and submit to a higher authority

John Locke

- Consent of the governed – Locke considered persons in their natural state as more cooperative and reasonable, and that society is formed through the consent individuals that organized it

Jean Jacques Rousseau

- General will – even if the people are the ones who organized the society, in extreme cases, the government is able to impose its will on the people

John Rawls

- Original position – humans having a veil of ignorance to see a just and a fair society

David Gauthier

- Self interest – an important factor in building and maintaining societies

Common Good

- society is founded on the concept of common good
 - desires to achieve the goal of survival and achieve well-being
- ex.

- peace within community
- clean and safe public spaces
- efficient transport system
- efficient public service.

DIFFERENT FORMS OF SOCIETY

Hunting and Gathering Societies

- earliest form of society
- people survive by hunting, trapping, fishing and gathering edible plants
- there is no specialization of labor

Pastoral society

- they rely on products obtained through the domestication and breeding of animals for transportation and food

Horticultural Societies

- They rely on the cultivation of fruits, vegetables, and plants in order to survive
- technology remains rather limited, people cultivate crops with the aid of digging sticks or hoes

Agricultural Societies

- They rely on the use of technology in order to cultivate crops in large areas
- The agricultural revolution led to an increase in food supplies, an increase in population, and the development of trade centers

Industrial Societies

- They depend on mechanization to produce goods and services
- Resulted in the industrial revolution, which in turn gave in rise to new production and industrial methods, as well as innovations in transportation and communication

Post-Industrial Society

- The focus on the manufacture of goods has been replaced by which people are involved in providing services for one another
 - virtual society

HUMAN AND SOCIETY

Human persons create and develop societies, while society influences how individuals think, behave, interact, and grow.

The relationship between the individual and society is important because both depend on each other for development and progress.

Human persons create and participate in society, while society provides rules, values, and norms that influence how individuals behave

HUMAN PERSON AS ORIENTED TOWARDS THEIR IMPENDING DEATH

Only in reflecting on the reality of death can we begin to explore and understand the meaning of our own existence.

DEATH

- commonly understood as the end of our functions
- separation of the spirit
- the human person is an embodied spirit

One can die for someone (sacrifice), but not in place of them existentially

Death = the possibility of no longer having any possibilities

INTRODUCTION TO PHILOSOPHY OF THE HUMAN PERSON



How should i live my life before it finally ends?

Self-determination

- Capacity to choose and act for oneself.
- A person can exercise freedom in choosing how to face the reality of death in their lives.
- We are the author and protagonist of our life.
- Accepting the fact that we have a limited time in this world allows us to determine the course of our life.
- Temporality challenges us to make choices that will be good for us and the people around us.
- Whenever we make a choice, we cannot undo that choices.

WHAT IS THE END OF THIS LIFE?

- Terminus- full stop or end of a line
- Telus- goal, purpose, or fulfillment

Death is not the goal of our life.

WHAT MAKES YOU HAPPY?

HAPPINESS

Ancient Greek philosophy

- considers it as an achievement
- it must be gained by living a productive and moral life.

Religious philosophers

- considers it as union with God

Contemporary views

- "whole-life satisfaction"
- based on our evaluation of our overall life experiences

Noble good

- pursued for its own sake
- it is good in itself

for example: love and friendship

Useful good

- considered good so long as it serves as a means to an end
- its goodness is found only from what it can provide

for example: money

Pleasurable good

- good so long as it provides some form of pleasure

Real happiness can be found in more permanent and meaningful things.

WHY DO WE SUFFER?

SUFFERING

takes place when we patiently endure unpleasantness, discomfort, and pain.

Physical suffering

- physical sensation such as discomfort, hunger, distress, and pain

Mental suffering

- involves emotional and mental states